

with its styling and speed at the Turin car show in 1965. This car show in a way paved the acceptance of supercar production within the automakers.

As we see, post Miura came a splurge of brands which were high-decibel in nature and carved a niche for themselves. These included Maserati Ghibli, Ferrari 365, GTB Daytona and the big daddy car, Lamborghini Countach. All these were supremely powerful, extremely quick and road rangers in themselves for a very long time - before the Porsche, Aston Martin, BMW, Bugatti's and Mercs came on board.

So, what's next? Is it going to be a high-powered flying car built around plutonium-based flux capacitor technology, as we would have seen in the sci-fi flicks, or are we expecting technology to create an altogether different niche?

That's something which would be interesting to speculate, and try to guess what the innovators are thinking about in this space. But before we move to that discussion, let's first understand the aspects with which supercars become that marvel, which ones can be classified under this category and considered as manmade miracles!

As Dave Pericak, the man behind the rise of Ford Motors and its performance division, once stated, "Supercars are not a big business, but using them as the pinnacle, we can develop technology and systems that you ultimately want to take into the rest of the line-up." It does hold true to a certain extent, but there are many other ramifications and usage of supercars, which can go beyond the R&D aspect



Ford GT

and bring forth the brand stature creation process overall.

Today, when automakers invest in these sensational feats of engineering and design, they go a lot beyond the maths and physics involved in it. They convert them into powerful beasts, faster sensations, expensive marvels that are extremely high-tech and most beautiful.

Some of the considerations kept in mind while producing these marvels would be their aerodynamic design, lighter and stronger structure, powerful engine and research around its creation, magical colours and new contours. And to define the elements let's look at some of the brands and the innovations that they are introducing now.

Ford is working on its GT Model, which is based on 3.5L ecoboost technology, complimenting Ford's ultra-efficient aerodynamics and design. Ecoboost is a pioneering technology, and a marketing term used by Ford Motors, to define turbo-charged direct-injection engines. The technology is equipped to deliver higher horse power, which can improve fuel efficiency by 30 per cent and control

greenhouse emissions. Now Ford proposes to use the technology in its hybrid variety as well. Ford believes, by using this tech intervention, they have now entered an area of competence which will lead them into great times ahead.

Bugatti Veyron, which had discontinued its production post 2015, has now unveiled Chiron. The president of Bugatti Wolfgang Dürheimer feels, "It is part of human nature to cross boundaries and set new records - to run 100 metres faster than ever before, to fly even further into space and to enter new realms. This striving is also our driving force at Bugatti." Chiron is expected to perform on the same lines as its president feels with 1490HP engine, generating 1180rpm torque, with an optimum speed of 300mph with a 0 - 60mph in 2.5 seconds! That's just a whiff once it touches the road. And car lovers would be waiting to get a first glimpse of this upcoming marvel and get bedazzled.

Year 2018 seems to be even more promising for supercars, and why supercars only. The other segments that are being differentiated by auto manufacturers are hyper and mega car segments. With increased focus on green and electric vehicles, the segment seems to be warming up both from an engineering and consumer aspiration point of view.

Supercar championships organised across various continents add value to the belief. Australia holds a key in this regard as it hosts one of the largest championships on the globe. So, as an advice to all automakers, and auto professionals, I would say, build your own dreams in this segment, or someone may hire you to build theirs.

I am sure, now if you hear VROOM, may be you are about to see a supercar or a superbike. So watch out! **EFY**



Lamborghini Countach